

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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Dear Buzz Solutions hiring team,

I am writing about the first Forward Deployed Engineer role. The job is to scope the inspection workflow before signature, deploy PowerAI into the systems the utility already runs, and turn the repeated pattern into something the next deployment can reuse. I live in Emeryville and can travel about 40% for customer sites and team onsites.

PowerAI is the visual inspection layer described on your site, and the \$20M Series A announced in August 2026 is aimed at scaling that product. From October 2023 I have sold and delivered my own client systems, and from August 2018 to December 2020 I built data pipelines at IBM. That is short of six years in a forward-deployed seat at a product company, and I have not worked in utility computer vision or GIS.

What I would do in the seat:

- **Pre-sales scoping:** discovery, a written in-and-out of scope, and a pilot on the customer's own files. That is how every StaffRoom engagement starts.
- **The integration:** Python or TypeScript, REST, webhooks, and data pipelines. One rebuild raised throughput 99.8% in four months. Claude Code and MCP are how I put an agent in front of a real user, with an evaluation held to 95% human agreement.
- **Field back to product:** I write the requirement and build the integration, then leave a playbook so the second deployment is shorter than the first.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome a conversation about what the first deployment, reporting to the CTO, needs to prove.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker